

# Cristian Lara

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## EDUCATION

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### Stanford University

*B.S. in Computer Science*

Stanford, CA

2014 – 2018

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Meta

*Software Engineer*

New York, NY

June 2024 – Present

Core contributor to primary UI for Meta's internal [Ax](#) experimentation platform for state-of-the-art black-box bayesian optimization. Worked closely with research scientists to productionize novel methods in experimentation for both offline (automl) and online (a/b testing) use cases.

#### Application Redesign

- Spearheaded the end-to-end redesign of the Ax experimentation UI, introducing new lifecycle tracking, improved navigation, and enhanced user experience.
- Delivered features such as experiment cloning, transfer learning integration, and advanced trial management, resulting in increased adoption and improved experimentation outcomes.

#### Open Source Excellence

- Upgraded Ax and BoTorch open-source documentation infrastructure (Docusaurus, Sphinx, ReadTheDocs)
- Fixed critical build and deployment issues, and synchronized cross-repo improvements.
- Enhanced onboarding and developer experience by improving docs, CI workflows, and automating versioning.

### Angaza

*Senior Software Engineer*

*Software Engineer*

San Francisco, CA

Jan 2022 – July 2023

July 2018 – Jan 2022

Owned and contributed to major projects involving building performant architecture using AWS with Terraform, scalable databases in Postgres, robust APIs in Python, web applications in ReactJS, and more.

#### Application Redesign

- Led a major 9-month project to overhaul the design of our entire frontend web application, resulting in a new component design system for more efficient frontend development and modern UX for improved customer sentiment.
- Onboarded and managed a team of engineering contractors to rapidly implement technical deliverables.
- Collaborated with product and design teams as lead technical advisor to manage scope and determine project roadmap.

#### Bulk SMS Campaigns

- Designed and implemented scalable infrastructure to support a platform for large SMS Campaigns.
- Built on Celery + RabbitMQ for a publish/subscriber event model.
- Infrastructure handles over 100 million SMS per year.

## PROJECTS

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### Stanford Pokemon ([github.com/CristianLara/stanford-pokemon](https://github.com/CristianLara/stanford-pokemon))

Stanford-themed Pokemon game engine implemented entirely from scratch using React.

### Personal Website ([github.com/CristianLara/cristianlara.github.io](https://github.com/CristianLara/cristianlara.github.io))

Interactive terminal to learn more about me built entirely from scratch using plain Javascript with no dependencies.

## ADDITIONAL

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**LANGUAGES:** English (native), Spanish (native), Turkish (proficient), Mandarin (basic)

**TECHNICAL SKILLS:** Python, Javascript, Java, C++; ReactJS, Redux, Webpack, Flask, Nginx, Postgres, AWS, Terraform

**INTERESTS:** Competitive Gaming, Photography, Keyboards, Cycling, Formula 1, Arduino + RPi, Ping Pong